

Julien Porschen

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IT Swiss Army Knife

Helping companies escape VMware lock-in
by designing and operating **open-source virtualization infrastructures**,
powered by **XCP-ng / Xen Orchestra**
and the **wider open-source ecosystem**.

Profile

IT professional since childhood, system engineer turned architect and company founder.
Over 20 years of experience in **Linux infrastructures, virtualization, automation** and **open-source technologies**, used in production across critical environments (banking, PSF, financial services, operators and public sector).

Pragmatic mindset focused on **simplicity, resilience, automation** and **knowledge sharing**.

Professional Experience

February 2026 - Present

Disruptive Minds - Co-Founder & Infrastructure Lead
Luxembourg

Co-founder and infrastructure lead of an IT infrastructure services company focused on open-source virtualization.

- Design and delivery of open-source virtualization architectures
 - Helping organizations migrate from VMware to XCP-ng / Xen Orchestra
 - Definition of infrastructure strategy, standards and technical governance
 - Design of resilient, automated and cost-efficient platforms
 - Advisory role on infrastructure modernization and sustainability
 - Optimizing open-source virtualization stacks: XCP-ng / Xen Orchestra, Proxmox, Red Hat Virtualization (oVirt), libvirt/KVM/QEMU
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June 2025 - January 2026

Upskilling & Entrepreneurial Project Preparation

- Deep dive into the **XCP-ng / Xen Orchestra** ecosystem
 - Design and testing of **VMware to XCP-ng migration scenarios**
 - Automation, architecture prototyping and operational best practices
 - Preparation of service offerings and go-to-market strategy
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April 2024 - May 2025

Nøelse – Group Infrastructure Director
Luxembourg

- Group-wide infrastructure leadership
 - Definition of technical and security standards
 - Supervision of multi-environment platforms
 - Designed and deployed an **XCP-ng / Xen Orchestra virtualization platform**
 - Led the exit from the VMware ecosystem toward open-source virtualization
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April 2023 - March 2024

NSI Luxembourg (CEGEKA Group) – Senior IT Consultant / System Engineer

- Consulting on system and cloud architectures
 - Technical reference and mentor
 - Promotion of automation best practices
 - Built an **XCP-ng / Xen Orchestra lab environment**
 - POCs, migration testing and team enablement
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July 2021 - April 2023

Mangopay – SysOps
Luxembourg

- Linux migration from Ubuntu to Red Hat (Satellite, IPA)
 - Centralized authentication using Azure Active Directory
 - Design of the AWS landing zone
 - Support for on-premise to cloud transition
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January 2021 - June 2021

Sogeti Luxembourg – Consultant

- Improved Red Hat Enterprise Linux deployment processes
 - Automated system compliance
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October 2018 - December 2020

ING Luxembourg – Ops Engineer

- Red Hat infrastructure modernization
 - Ansible Tower implementation
 - Elasticsearch cluster for logs, metrics and APM
 - Containerization initiatives
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February 2017 - September 2018

EBRC – Senior System Engineer
Luxembourg

- Integration and operation of IT infrastructures for financial clients
 - Technical architect role for a major banking customer
 - Highly available system architecture design
 - Red Hat Virtualization (RHV, based on oVirt) infrastructure management and administration - Automation using Ansible
 - Monitoring, supervision and level 3 production support
 - Mentoring of junior system engineers
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February 2016 - January 2017

atHome Group – Senior System Engineer
Luxembourg

- Production platform operations
 - Disaster Recovery solution deployment
 - Automated system management and deployments
 - Monitoring redesign
 - Federated authentication system design
 - AWS environment preparation
 - Docker Swarm cluster deployment
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Earlier Experience

2013 - 2016

CTG Luxembourg PSF – System & Security Administrator / Application Support

- Assignments for **Clearstream** and **Banque Internationale à Luxembourg (BIL)**
 - Linux administration and hardening
 - Banking application support and infrastructure coordination
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2001 - 2013

French Ministry of the Interior – System & Network Administrator

- Systems and network administration for critical infrastructures
 - Automation and large-scale monitoring
 - High availability and business continuity
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Education

- **DEUG in Applied Mathematics & Computer Science**
University of Strasbourg (Louis Pasteur)
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Certifications

- Red Hat Certified Specialist in Ansible Automation — 2018

- Red Hat Certified System Administrator (RHCSA) - RHEL 7 — 2017
 - ITIL v3 Foundation
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Languages

- French: Native
- English: Full Professional
- German: Intermediate